

Turn Trump regret into a November no-show

A fast, measured ad program for soft 2024 Trump voters. Whit Pendergast, Hoplight. September 23, 2026, for donor and experiment advisers.

THE EDGE

Talk to them inside their own values, in a voice they trust.

81 from 56

Republican agreement on a pay message with a frame from Hoplight's message tool, in a randomized trial of 3,006 US adults. The staff-written message reached 70. With religious conservatives on union support, 55 to 71 where the staff message fell to 51.

Creative that Meta already runs, and people already stop for.

6.5M views

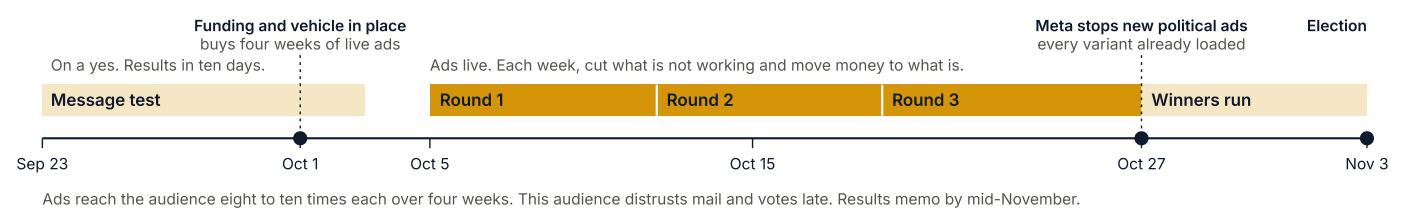
Ten months of Epstein-themed creative inside close to \$1 million of Meta ads for a commercial activist brand Whit co-founded. Review let it through when it implied, people stopped for it like anything else on the account, and clicks cost 18 percent less.

Tested before a dollar goes to ads. Measured after.

1 in 5 regret their vote

Navigator Research, September 2026: the Iran war and rising costs top the reasons. Almost nobody is working this audience. A randomized message test picks the betrayal and the frame, then a held-out slice of the voter list measures the effect on enthusiasm and turnout.

TIMELINE TO NOVEMBER 3



WHAT EACH LEVEL OF INVESTMENT BUYS

An answer

Which betrayal and which frame move soft Trump voters, from a randomized survey test among 2024 Trump voters, in about ten days. A tested message set and a go or no-go before any ad money moves.

\$35K · no vehicle needed

Proof in one state

The winning messages run four weeks to about 800,000 soft Trump voters in one Senate state or a set of House districts, with a held-out control. A measured effect on enthusiasm and turnout, and a playbook that works again.

\$180K · \$95K of it in ads

A result that replicates

The same run in four states or district sets, about 3 million people, each with its own holdout. A finding that holds across places instead of resting on one, and messages and audiences carried into 2028.

\$475K · \$340K of it in ads

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

	ANSWER	ONE STATE	FOUR STATES
Ads on Meta	0	\$95K	\$340K
Randomized message test	\$24K	\$24K	\$24K
In -field measurement, designed with your advisers	0	\$25K	\$50K
Creative, at cost	\$3K	\$9K	\$16K
Hoplight: messages, copy, ad operations, results memo	\$8K	\$27K	\$45K
Total	\$35K	\$180K	\$475K

WHAT IT NEEDS BESIDES MONEY

An existing C4 or PAC with a neutral or right-of-center brand, Meta's political ad approval already in hand, and an ad account with spending history. Its counsel clears each ad. Hoplight runs the campaign and does not own the vehicle.

STRATEGIC CHOICES FOR ADVISERS

Where. One Senate state, or a set of close House districts.

Measurement. Held-out areas with a short survey, or person-level randomization if the vehicle already tests.

Vehicle type. A C4 while ads name only Trump and the issues. Naming a 2026 candidate moves it to a PAC.

A third issue. Rising costs adds two test arms, about \$6K to \$12K.

Added channels. Volunteer sharing and image texts ride on the same creative.